

QUINE AND STRAWSON

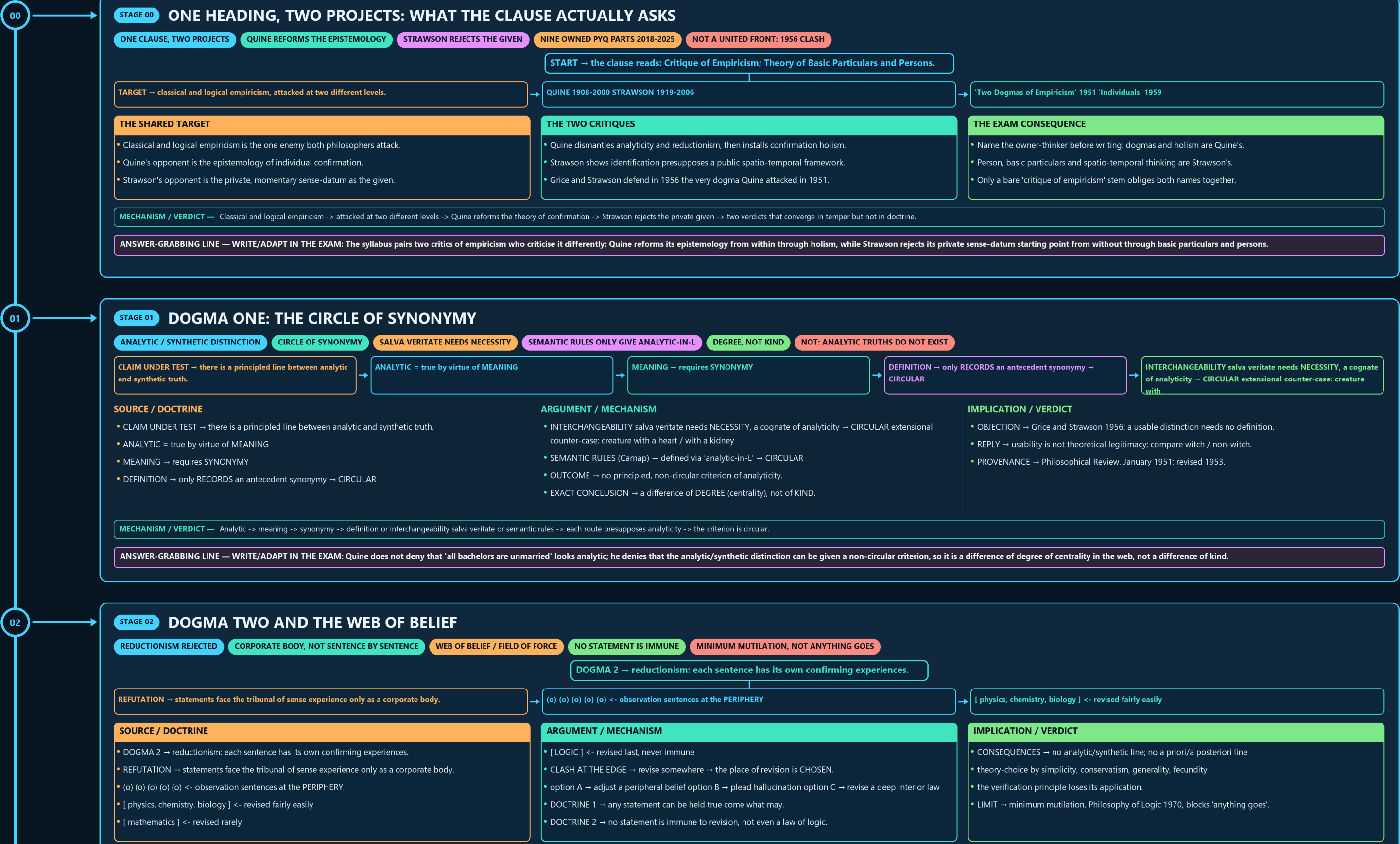
ONE HEADING, TWO PROJECTS → DOGMA ONE: THE CIRCLE → DOGMA TWO AND THE → THE DUHEM-QUINE MACHINERY AND → RADICAL TRANSLATION, GAVAGAI AND → QUINE'S POSITIVE SYSTEM AND

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

PRIMARY CORE FLOW SUBORDINATE EXTRA APPROVAL / REVIEW

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • source generation g2 and all prior artifacts unchanged

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles



02

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Analytic -> meaning -> synonymy -> definition or interchangeability salva veritate or semantic rules -> each route presupposes analyticity -> the criterion is circular.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Quine does not deny that 'all bachelors are unmarried' looks analytic; he denies that the analytic/synthetic distinction can be given a non-circular criterion, so it is a difference of degree of centrality in the web, not a difference of kind.

STAGE 02

DOGMA TWO AND THE WEB OF BELIEF

REDUCTIONISM REJECTEDCORPORATE BODY, NOT SENTENCE BY SENTENCEWEB OF BELIEF / FIELD OF FORCENO STATEMENT IS IMMUNE

MINIMUM MUTILATION, NOT ANYTHING GOES

DOGMA 2 → reductionism: each sentence has its own confirming experiences.

REFUTATION → statements face the tribunal of sense experience only as a corporate body.

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- DOGMA 2 → reductionism: each sentence has its own confirming experiences.
- REFUTATION → statements face the tribunal of sense experience only as a corporate body.
- (o) (o) (o) (o) (o) <- observation sentences at the PERIPHERY
- [physics, chemistry, biology] <- revised fairly easily
- [mathematics] <- revised rarely

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- [LOGIC] <- revised last, never immune
- CLASH AT THE EDGE → revise somewhere → the place of revision is CHOSEN.
- option A → adjust a peripheral belief option B → plead hallucination option C → revise a deep interior law
- DOCTRINE 1 → any statement can be held true come what may.
- DOCTRINE 2 → no statement is immune to revision, not even a law of logic.

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- CONSEQUENCES → no analytic/synthetic line; no a priori/a posteriori line
- theory-choice by simplicity, conservatism, generality, fecundity
- the verification principle loses its application.
- LIMIT → minimum mutilation, Philosophy of Logic 1970, blocks 'anything goes'.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Individual confirmation is impossible -> statements face experience as a corporate body -> the web of belief -> revision is chosen, not dictated -> pragmatic virtues govern theory-choice.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Confirmation holism replaces individual verification with a web of belief whose interior is protected by choice rather than by immunity, so any sentence may be saved and none is beyond revision, but only at a stated cost elsewhere in the system.

03

STAGE 03

THE DUHEM-QUINE MACHINERY AND ITS TWO AUTHORS

(H & A) IMPLIES OMODUS TOLLENS HITS THE CONJUNCTION

NEPTUNE 1846 / VULCAN THEN RELATIVITY 1915

DUHEM 1906 IS NOT QUINE 1951

POPPER AND LAKATOS ACCEPT THE LOGIC

Axis	DUHEM 1906	QUINE 1951
Scope	theoretical physics only	the whole of science
Logic & maths	exempt	included; none immune
Corollary	no experimentum crucis	underdetermination

SYSTEM / DOCTRINE

- TESTABLE CLAIM → (H & A) implies O, where A is background theory and conditions.
- OBSERVATION → NOT-O
- MODUS TOLLENS → NOT (H & A) only: H is false OR some element of A is false.
- LOGIC IS SILENT → the conjunct to surrender is not dictated by the evidence.
- RESULT → refutation is never conclusive against a single statement

DECISIVE DISTINCTION

- DUHEM 1906
- QUINE 1951
- theoretical physics only
- the whole of science
- Logic & maths

EVALUATION / TRAP

- no experimentum crucis
- CASE 1 → Uranus: revise the auxiliary → NEPTUNE, Le Verrier and Adams, 1846.
- CASE 2 → Mercury: 'VULCAN' fails → revise the deep law → relativity, 1915.
- REPLIES → Popper: falsification is a methodological decision, not pure logic.
- Lakatos: hard core plus revisable protective belt.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — (H and A) implies O -> observation gives not-O -> modus tollens yields not-(H and A) -> logic is silent on the conjunct -> revision is a pragmatic choice -> individual verifiability has no application.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: The Duhem-Quine thesis is the machinery behind holism: because the testable unit is a conjunction of hypothesis and auxiliaries, modus tollens condemns the conjunction and leaves the choice of revision to pragmatic judgement rather than to evidence.

04

STAGE 04

RADICAL TRANSLATION, GAVAGAI AND THE THREE RESULTS

RADICAL TRANSLATION

ONE STIMULUS MEANING, FIVE READINGS

APPARATUS OF INDIVIDUATION IN DISPUTE

INSCRUTABILITY THEN INDETERMINACY

CHOMSKY: ONLY UNDERDETERMINATION

SET-UP → radical translation: no dictionary, no interpreter; evidence is stimulation plus assent or dissent

A rabbit runs past; the native says 'Gavagai'.

'rabbit' 'undetached 'temporal 'rabbithood' 'it is rabbiting' rabbit- stage of a (universal (feature-placing

parts' rabbit' instantiated) no object at all) all share ONE stimulus meaning

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

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ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- ASK 'same gavagai?' → presupposes the identity predicate, articles, plurals, quantifiers: the APPARATUS OF INDIVIDUATION in dispute.
- RESULT 1 → INSCRUTABILITY OF REFERENCE: no fact about what the terms refer to.
- RESULT 2 → INDETERMINACY OF TRANSLATION: rival analytical hypotheses agree on all observation sentences yet differ elsewhere; nothing decides.
- RESULT 3 → ONTOLOGICAL RELATIVITY: reference only relative to a background manual.

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- PREMISES → behaviourism about evidence; verificationism about facts; naturalism.
- OBJECTIONS → Chomsky: only underdetermination. Davidson: harmless, scale-like.

QUINE AND STRAWSON • TILE 2/5 • same master rows 2220-5454 of 12112 • continues below

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: The Duhem-Quine thesis is the machinery behind holism: because the testable unit is a conjunction of hypothesis and auxiliaries, modus tollens condemns the conjunction and leaves the choice of revision to pragmatic judgement rather than to evidence.

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MECHANISM / VERDICT — One stimulus meaning -> several rival term-translations -> the identity question presupposes individuation -> reference is inscrutable -> rival manuals agree on all observation sentences -> translation is indeterminate -> reference is theory-relative.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Gavagai is not a curiosity but the constructive completion of Two Dogmas: the circle showed that analyticity cannot be defined, and radical translation shows why, because there are no determinate meanings for a definition to capture.

05

STAGE 05 QUINE'S POSITIVE SYSTEM AND THE REFORM OF EMPIRICISM

TO BE IS TO BE A BOUND VARIABLE

REGIMENT AND AUDIT THE QUANTIFIERS

NATURALIZED EPISTEMOLOGY 1968/69

EMPIRICISM WITHOUT THE DOGMAS

NOT DATED TO TWO DOGMAS 1951

QUESTION 1 → what is there?

CRITERION → 'to be is to be the value of a bound variable', On What

METHOD → regiment best science into first-order logic; audit its quantifiers.

CONSEQUENCE → commitment is relative to the regimentation → ontological relativity.

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- QUESTION 1 → what is there?
- CRITERION → 'to be is to be the value of a bound variable', On What There Is 1948.
- METHOD → regiment best science into first-order logic; audit its quantifiers.
- CONSEQUENCE → commitment is relative to the regimentation → ontological relativity.
- QUESTION 2 → how do we know?

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- ANSWER → naturalized epistemology; philosophy continuous with science,
- 'a chapter of psychology', 1968/69; sensory input to theoretical output.
- IMAGE → Neurath's boat: rebuilt plank by plank at sea, never in dry dock.
- QUESTION 3 → what happens to the a priori?
- CHARGE → no non-circular analyticity + universal revisability + no first philosophy = holding a belief a priori is a metaphysical article of faith.

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- QUESTION 4 → is empiricism abandoned?
- ANSWER → no: empiricism WITHOUT the dogmas; experience still governs belief, holistically rather than sentence by sentence.
- BRIDGE → later Wittgenstein converges (museum myth rejected, holism, anti-private) but parts on method: Quine REFORMS by regimentation,
- Wittgenstein DESCRIBES.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Dogmas fall -> a positive system is owed -> quantifiers fix commitment -> regimentation makes commitment theory-relative -> epistemology is naturalised -> empiricism survives in holistic form.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Quine does not reject empiricism but purifies it: experience still governs belief, yet only holistically, ontology is read off regimented science, and epistemology becomes a chapter of natural science rather than its a priori foundation.

06

STAGE 06 STRAWSON'S BASIC PARTICULARS AND THE IDENTIFICATION FRAMEWORK

DESCRIPTIVE, NOT REVISIONARY

RE-IDENTIFICATION IS THE HINGE

ONE PUBLIC SPATIO-TEMPORAL FRAMEWORK

MATERIAL BODIES ARE BASIC

AUDITORY WORLD NEEDS A MASTER-SOUND

METHOD → DESCRIPTIVE metaphysics: describe the scheme we actually use.

contrast → REVISIONARY: Descartes, Leibniz, Berkeley propose a better scheme.

provenance → Individuals 1959, 'An Essay in Descriptive Metaphysics'.

DEFINITION → a BASIC PARTICULAR is identifiable without identifying anything else.

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- ARGUMENT FROM RE-IDENTIFICATION

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- 2 re-identification requires ONE unified spatio-temporal system
- 3 material bodies constitute it: three-dimensional, enduring, publicly located
- 4 sounds, events, private experiences are identified only BY reference to bodies
- 5 therefore MATERIAL BODIES are basic; PERSONS are the second basic particular
- STATUS → conceptual dependence, not causal or metaphysical priority.

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- MASTER-SOUND whose pitch fixes position → a space-analogue is reintroduced.
- VERDICT → the experiment supports the thesis rather than defeating it.
- OBJECTION → Evans: the construction may smuggle in spatial notions.
- 2020 LINK → spatio-temporal thinking is a precondition of OBJECTIVE thinking.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Quine does not reject empiricism but purifies it: experience still governs belief, yet only holistically, ontology is read off regimented science, and epistemology becomes a chapter of natural science rather than its a priori foundation.

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MECHANISM / VERDICT — Objective thought -> requires re-identification -> requires one unified spatio-temporal system -> constituted by material bodies -> everything else is identified through them -> bodies are basic.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Material bodies are basic particulars because objective thought requires re-identifying a particular as the same one again, re-identification requires a single public spatio-temporal framework, and only enduring bodies constitute such a framework.

07

STAGE 07 PERSONS: THE PREDICATE MATRIX AND THE DOUBLE DEMOLITION

PERSON IS LOGICALLY PRIMITIVE

M-PREDICATES AND P-PREDICATES

SELF-ASCRPTION NEEDS OTHER-ASCRPTION

BLOCKS DUALISM AND NO-OWNERSHIP

NOT LOGICAL BEHAVIOURISM

M-PREDICATES

'weighs 70 kg'

P-PREDICATES also true of mere

observation or criteria → ASYMMETRY

states of consciousness and action; only persons material bodies

others by behavioural criteria; self without

SYSTEM / DOCTRINE

- THESIS → the concept of a PERSON is logically PRIMITIVE; not mind plus body assembled.
- P-PREDICATES also true of mere
- states of consciousness and action; only persons material bodies
- others by behavioural criteria; self without
- 'weighs 70 kg'

DECISIVE DISTINCTION

- observation or criteria → ASYMMETRY
- 1 I self-ascribe P-predicates ('I am in pain')
- 2 a self-ascribable predicate must be understood as ascribable to others
- 3 other-ascription requires identifying others as single M-and-P subjects
- 4 therefore the person concept is presupposed by self-ascription itself

EVALUATION / TRAP

- BLOCKS CARTESIAN DUALISM BLOCKS THE NO-OWNERSHIP THEORY two independent substances cannot 'the experiences had by this body' be the ONE subject
- P-predicates covertly restores the ownership it become unlearnable and other minds denies
- Schlick and Lichtenberg's unknowable 'it thinks' is self-refuting
- GUARD → not logical behaviourism; behaviour is criterial evidence, not meaning.
- OBJECTIONS → co-instantiation rather than primitiveness; Ayer on no-ownership.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Self-ascription of P-predicates -> presupposes understanding their other-ascription -> presupposes identifying others as single M-and-P subjects -> the person concept is presupposed -> person is primitive.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Self-ascription of experience presupposes other-ascription, other-ascription requires identifying others as single subjects of both bodily and conscious predicates, and therefore the concept of a person is logically primitive rather than assembled from mind and body.

08

STAGE 08 REFERENCE, PRESUPPOSITION AND STRAWSON'S OWN ANTI-EMPIRICISM

PEOPLE REFER, SENTENCES MEAN

PRESUPPOSED, NOT ASSERTED

TRUTH-VALUE GAP, NOT FALSITY

FIVE ANTI-EMPIRICIST LINES

DESCRIPTIVE SCOPE IS A REAL LIMIT

Issue

Who refers

Existence

Empty term

Meaning

RUSSELL, On Denoting 1905

the sentence, by quantifier

ASSERTED in the analysis

the statement is FALSE

truth-conditions of a type

STRAWSON, On Referring

people, in a USE

PRESUPPOSED, not asserted

a TRUTH-VALUE GAP

rules for correct use

SYSTEM / DOCTRINE

- TEST SENTENCE → 'The present King of France is bald' (there is no such king).
- RUSSELL, On Denoting 1905
- STRAWSON, On Referring
- Who refers
- the sentence, by quantifier

DECISIVE DISTINCTION

- Empty term
- the statement is FALSE
- a TRUTH-VALUE GAP
- truth-conditions of a type
- rules for correct use

EVALUATION / TRAP

- 2 bundle and no-ownership selves collapse → person is primitive [Individuals 3]
- 3 reference abstracted from use is a mistake [On Referring]
- 4 the global demand to justify induction is senseless [Logical Theory 1952]
- 5 objectivity needs a framework not drawn from experience [Bounds of Sense 1966]
- FORM → take an undisputed fact, ask its conditions, show the empiricist materials fail.

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PEOPLE REFER, SENTENCES MEAN PRESUPPOSED, NOT ASSERTED TRUTH-VALUE GAP, NOT FALSITY FIVE ANTI-EMPIRICIST LINES DESCRIPTIVE SCOPE IS A REAL LIMIT

Issue	RUSSELL, On Denoting 1905	STRAWSON, On Referring
Who refers	the sentence, by quantifier	people, in a USE
Existence	ASSERTED in the analysis	PRESUPPOSED, not asserted
Empty term	the statement is FALSE	a TRUTH-VALUE GAP
Meaning	truth-conditions of a type	rules for correct use
SYSTEM / DOCTRINE	DECISIVE DISTINCTION	EVALUATION / TRAP
• TEST SENTENCE → 'The present King of France is bald' (there is no such king). • RUSSELL, On Denoting 1905 • STRAWSON, On Referring • Who refers • the sentence, by quantifier	• Empty term • the statement is FALSE • a TRUTH-VALUE GAP • truth-conditions of a type • rules for correct use	• 2 bundle and no-ownership selves collapse → person is primitive [Individuals 3] • 3 reference abstracted from use is a mistake [On Referring] • 4 the global demand to justify induction is senseless [Logical Theory 1952] • 5 objectivity needs a framework not drawn from experience [Bounds of Sense 1966] • FORM → take an undisputed fact, ask its conditions, show the empiricist materials fail.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Meaning belongs to the sentence-type as rules -> truth-value arises only in a use -> the definite article presupposes existence -> failure yields a gap -> the same logic makes identification depend on a public framework.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Sentences do not refer, people refer in a use on an occasion, so existence is presupposed rather than asserted and reference-failure produces a truth-value gap; the same anti-atomism makes the given public rather than private.

09

STAGE 09 CONFRONTATION, CONVERGENCE AND THE REUSABLE ANSWER SPINE

REVISABLE THEORY OR PRESUPPOSED FRAME METHOD MIRRORS DOCTRINE ANTI-CARTESIAN PUBLIC ANCHOR LAYERED VERDICT, NOT A WINNER THEY BASICALLY AGREE IS A TRAP



SOURCE / DOCTRINE	ARGUMENT / MECHANISM	IMPLICATION / VERDICT
• descriptive metaphysics • revisable come what may • core is indispensable • behavioural, indeterminate • fixed by public criteria	• the public spatio-temporal • CONVERGENCES → anti-Cartesian about a private inner object • the public and structured replaces the atomic and private • the museum myth of determinate private meanings is rejected by both. • DO NOT OVERSTATE → they differ on status, meaning and method; 'they basically agree' is the standing trap on comparative stems.	• ANSWER SPINE → 1 decode the directive and name the owner-thinker • 2 thesis in one line • 3 mechanism with the exact term • 4 objection and reply, objector named • 5 graded verdict with a provenance-clean date

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Two critiques of one target -> opposite views of the scheme's status -> mirrored methods -> genuine convergences in temper -> a layered verdict on revisability.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Quine and Strawson attack empiricism from opposite ends and leave one standing question: the periphery of the scheme is Quineanly revisable, yet some framework role of a public world and re-identifiable subjects looks Strawsonianly indispensable.

E

EXTRA SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT ADVANCED SESSION 1 — TWO-PROJECT MAP - ONE SYLLABUS ADVANCED SESSION 2 — QUINE, DOGMA 1 - THE ADVANCED SESSION 3 — QUINE, DOGMA 2 AND THE ADVANCED SESSION 4 — THE DUHEM-QUINE THESIS - WHY ADVANCED SESSION 5 — RADICAL TRANSLATION AND 'GAVAGAI' ADVANCED SESSION 6 — ONTOLOGICAL COMMITMENT, NATURALIZED EPISTEMOLOGY AND ADVANCED SESSION 7 — STRAWSON'S BASIC PARTICULARS - MATERIAL

OPTIONAL SOURCE WITNESS	ADVANCED OBJECTION	COMPARATIVE NUANCE
• ADVANCED SESSION 1 — Two-Project Map - One Syllabus Heading, Two Philosophers, Two Different Critiques of Empiricism • ADVANCED SESSION 2 — Quine, Dogma 1 - The Analytic/Synthetic Distinction and the Circle of Synonymy • ADVANCED SESSION 3 — Quine, Dogma 2 and the Positive Doctrine - Reductionism Rejected, Confirmation Holism and the Web of Belief • ADVANCED SESSION 4 — The Duhem-Quine Thesis - Why No Single Hypothesis Faces Experience Alone	• ADVANCED SESSION 5 — Radical Translation and 'Gavagai' - Inscrutability of Reference and Indeterminacy of Translation • ADVANCED SESSION 6 — Ontological Commitment, Naturalized Epistemology and Ontological Relativity - and Quine's Convergence with the Later Wittgenstein • ADVANCED SESSION 7 — Strawson's Basic Particulars - Material Bodies and the Single Spatio-Temporal Framework • ADVANCED SESSION 8 — Strawson's Persons - The Primitive Concept, M/P-Predicates, and the Block on Dualism	• ADVANCED SESSION 9 — 'On Referring' versus Russell, and Strawson as a Critic of Empiricism • ADVANCED SESSION 10 — Synthesis - Quine versus Strawson, Their Convergences, and the Universal Answer Spine • ADVANCED DOSSIER REFINEMENTS — USE SELECTIVELY • The shared item is a target , not a shared thesis.

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.